

**Press F1**

The Department of Consumer Affairs suggests that the first course of action when a company reneges on its service responsibilities, is to call the National Consumer Helpline, on 1800-11-4000.

The continuing saga of readers' problems with HP laptops

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Last month we described the problems that three readers have experienced. Manoj Nair has had the motherboard in his Compaq Presario V3225AU repaired or replaced a total of eight times! He told us that HP had told him that this laptop was basically not suitable for India and that the company had published an internal advisory note about this. Another reader, Nishant Mohan, told us of similar problems with the same model laptop.

Dr. Sanjay Tharoor told us of repeated motherboard problems with his HP Pavilion Laptop DV9312TX. His motherboard has so far failed three times.

We first contacted HP regarding some of these problems at the end of March - two months before the present time of writing. Apart from one problem regarding printer cartridges, none of the issues we raised at that time with laptops have been resolved, but HP has taken action on the most recent pair of complaints that we sent over. These were from readers Sumir Josan and Kiruba Karan.

Sumir Josan has also experienced overheating with his HP Pavilion dv2701TX special edition laptop. He soon noticed that the machine was overheating, so much so that the



area to the left of the touchpad was too hot to touch. The fan and motherboard were replaced by HP - taking a whole month to do so, as other readers have pointed out - but the overheating problem continued. For a second time his machine was returned, the heatsink was changed, but still the overheating problem persisted. He returned that machine to HP, and in his own words, he was told: "overheating was a normal issue with laptops having Nvidia graphics card." Overheating to the extent that the surface of the laptop is too hot to touch?

No wonder this reader is "fed up of constantly going to the service centre" with a problem that never gets resolved. Digit has been told by HP that "As for the issues Mr. Sumir Josan is facing, we have escalated the issue to the right department and someone from our team will get in touch

In last month's issue of Digit we reported on the fact that a large number of our readers have complained to us of service problems with Hewlett-Packard. In fact, nearly half of all the service problems described to us by readers had concerned HP, and they are still coming in. We check each of these, and pass on to HP those that seem to have the strongest cases

with him sometime next week." We'll report the results of this in our July issue.

As for reader Kiruba Karan, he purchased an HP Pavilion dv8216tx Notebook PC in September 2007. This is not a cheap machine, and cost about Rs. 81,000. It eventually developed display problems and HP took two months to repair these by replacing the display. According to our reader, in order to get this done, the dealer from whom he purchased the machine

had to apply pressure on the service centre in Chennai. Subsequently, the problem surfaced again, with many lines appearing on the screen.

He took the machine to the service centre and was told that servicing the panel would cost about Rs. 25,000 and would take more than two months - the panel needed to

Write in

If you have a genuine example of truly bad service, such as a product going wrong within warranty and the supplier refusing to fix or replace it, then please let us know at: servicewatch@thinkdigit.com. Make sure that you have proper documentation (receipt, etc) to back up your complaint. We cannot promise even to reply to all the emails we will receive, but we will pick a selection and take them up with the relevant companies at the highest level.

come from outside of India. He managed to get a friend to pick up a replacement in the US for Rs. 9,000, but HP here in India refused to fix this new panel as they would not fix spares purchased from third parties! He got onto us after sending a complaint to HP that was ignored.

At last, HP has now contacted him after we passed on his complaint, and we will report next month on any progress. **E**



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